A Survey

Abstract. We counted birds along a river over three days and report the totals below for all species.

The survey team left at dawn and walked [L]
north along the dry river bed, counting
every heron they saw on the far bank.
By noon the heat was heavy and they
rested under the old fig near the ford.

In the afternoon the second team took [R]
the boat downstream to the salt flats,
where the water turned grey and still.
They logged forty plovers and a pair
of spoonbills feeding in the shallows.